Observation Sheet

A record for one bounded place, plot or observation frame. The eight categories are a land-based starter grammar, not universal indicators or a score. Adapt, replace or leave them unused through local knowledge. Format 2 v1.3 · August 2026 · Candidate tool.

Place / frame / privacy code: _____ **Date / time / duration:** _____

Weather / conditions: _____ **Observer:** _____

Describe before interpreting. Record what was directly noticed and the effort or conditions of observation. No category is inherently good or bad outside its ecological, cultural and practical context.

Species: possible identification is not confirmation. "Not observed" is not proof of absence.

1 Surface and soil cover

What covers the surface, and where?

Optional descriptive cue:
covered · partial · bare · N/A / unknown

2 Vegetation structure

What layers or patterns are present?

Optional descriptive cue:
layered · mixed · single layer · N/A / unknown

3 Water behaviour

Where does water move, remain or enter the soil?

Optional descriptive cue:
infiltrates · pools / holds · runs off · N/A / unknown

4 Change and succession

What appears to establish, hold, decline or reset?

Optional descriptive cue:
establishing · holding · declining / resetting · N/A / unknown

5 Species and signs

What organisms or signs were observed?

Optional descriptive cue:
observed · possible ID · not observed · N/A / unknown

6 Soil signals

What did you notice in smell, texture, roots or organisms?

Optional descriptive cue:
active signs · mixed · compacted / unknown · N/A / unknown

7 Organic matter

What organic matter is produced, moved, returned or removed?

Optional descriptive cue:
returned · moved / retained · removed · N/A / unknown

8 Human rhythm

What did the work require from the people carrying it?

Optional descriptive cue:
carried · strained · not sustainable · N/A / unknown

NOTES Keep different kinds of knowing separately readable

Direct observation / measurement and method

Lived experience / local knowledge and whose

Interpretation / working hypothesis / confidence

Source, photo or specimen reference / what remains unknown

Remember: Identification remains corrigible; check lookalikes and relevant local knowledge. Protect sensitive species, places and people. Share local knowledge only with consent. A blank or uncertainty is useful evidence of the limits of this visit.

What did this visit make possible to notice?